

# Accessible forms and navigation

Module 1 - Lesson 3

## Overview

Forms and navigation are the interactive heart of most websites. Accessibility here means every label is programmatically connected to its control, keyboard users can operate everything, and focus is always visible.

## Key Concepts

- Every input needs a <label> connected via for/id, or wrapped inside the label element.
- Use fieldset/legend to group related controls such as radio buttons or checkboxes.
- Convey errors with both color and text, and use aria-describedby to link error messages to the field.
- Navigation links must be reachable by keyboard and show a clear visible focus state.
- Use <button> for actions and <a> for navigation; never fake a button with a div.
- Respect native HTML behavior before adding JavaScript: required, min/max, type, and autocomplete improve usability for free.

## Example

```
<form>
  <label for="email">Email address</label>
  <input id="email" type="email" required
    autocomplete="email"
    aria-describedby="email-error" />
  <p id="email-error" role="alert">Enter a valid email.</p>
</form>
```

## Summary

Accessible forms connect labels to inputs, group related fields, and explain errors clearly. Accessible navigation stays keyboard-operable with visible focus and uses the correct semantic elements.

## Practice Checklist

- Write a form where every field has a programmatically connected label.
- Group a set of radio options with fieldset/legend and test it with a screen reader.
- Tab through a page using only the keyboard and verify the focus ring is always visible.